Question ID: f237ccfc

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Equivalent expressions	Medium

Question

The sum of $-2x^2+x+31$ and $3x^2+7x-8$ can be written in the form ax^2+bx+c, where a, b, and c are constants. What is the value of $a+b+c$?

Rationale

The correct answer is 32. The sum of the given expressions is $(-2x^2+x+31)+(3x^2+7x-8)$. Combining like terms yields $x^2+8x+23$. Based on the form of the given equation, $a=1$, $b=8$, and $c=23$. Therefore, $a+b+c=32$.

Alternate approach: Because $a+b+c$ is the value of ax^2+bx+c when $x=1$, it is possible to first make that substitution into each polynomial before adding them. When $x=1$, the first polynomial is equal to $-2+1+31=30$ and the second polynomial is equal to $3+7-8=2$. The sum of 30 and 2 is 32.